脱水(だっすい)と 食欲(しょくよく)：少(すこ)しずつ 飲(の)む

Dehydration & Appetite Loss — Offer, Don't Push, Report the Amount — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Notice the early signs of dehydration and appetite loss: see what was left on the tray, ask about pain, offer fluids little by little as an invitation he can refuse, let him choose the drink, praise the amount he takes, come back at a set time, and report the amount — not an impression.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana (caregiver)

山田(やまだ)さん、お昼(ひる)は 半分(はんぶん)でしたね。

Yamada-san, you had half your lunch today.

Why: Look at the tray before you say anything. Half a lunch left and the tea untouched is where dehydration starts in an older resident — notice it kindly, as a fact.

Yamada-san (resident)

あまり 食欲(しょくよく)が ないんです。

I don't have much appetite.

Why: 食欲(しょくよく) is appetite. Losing it can come from pain, a sore mouth, a fever or low mood. You do not guess which — you notice, ask, and pass it on.

Hana (caregiver)

どこか 痛(いた)いですか。

Does anything hurt?

Why: Ask before you offer food again. If something hurts, that changes what comes next — and it goes to the nurse first.

Yamada-san (resident)

いいえ。でも、少(すこ)し だるいです。

No. But I feel a bit sluggish.

Why: だるい — heavy, tired, sluggish — is easy to wave away. Next to a poor appetite it is one of the quiet signs of 脱水(だっすい), dehydration. Remember the word.

Hana (caregiver)

お茶(ちゃ)は 飲(の)みましたか。

Have you had your tea?

Why: Check drinks, not only food. Look at the cup as well as asking — a full cup answers the question more honestly than a polite yes.

Yamada-san (resident)

いいえ、喉(のど)は 渇(かわ)いて いません。

No, I'm not thirsty.

Why: The most common answer, and the reason dehydration is missed. Older people feel thirst less, so 'not thirsty' does not mean 'had enough'. Accept it, and still offer.

Hana (caregiver)

少しずつ 飲みませんか。

How about drinking a little at a time?

Why: THE RULE OF THIS EPISODE, first half. Offer, do not push. 〜ませんか invites him and leaves him free to say no; small sips, often, do more than one big cup.

Yamada-san (resident)

冷たい お茶なら、飲めます。

If it's cold tea, I can drink that.

Why: Now you know what he will take. Cold or warm, tea or water — the choice is his, and a drink he likes is a drink he finishes.

Hana (caregiver)

では、冷たい お茶を お持ちしますね。

Then I'll bring you some cold tea.

Why: お持ちします is the humble 'I'll bring it' (Ep 3). Follow his choice straight away — it shows him the choice was real.

Hana (caregiver)

一口だけでも 大丈夫ですよ。

Even just one sip is fine.

Why: THE RULE, second half. Lower the bar. A resident told one sip counts will often take three; one told to finish the cup often takes none.

Yamada-san (resident)

ああ、おいしいです。

Ah, that's nice.

Why: Let him drink at his own pace, sitting upright (Ep 3). Do not refill the cup the moment he puts it down.

Hana (caregiver)

コップ 半分 飲めましたね。

You managed half a cup.

Why: Look at the cup and say the amount out loud, warmly. It praises him, and it fixes the number in your head for the report.

Yamada-san (resident)

もう 少し あとで 飲みます。

I'll have a bit more later.

Why: He is setting his own pace, and that is fine. Your job is to make 'later' real — by coming back, not by hoping he remembers.

Hana (caregiver)

3時に また 来ますね。

I'll come back at three.

Why: Name a time and keep it. Small drinks spread across the afternoon are how dehydration is prevented — and a promise kept is why he says yes next time.

Hana (caregiver)

だるい ことは、看護師(かんごし)に 伝(つた)えますね。

I'll tell the nurse that you feel sluggish.

Why: A poor appetite plus だるい goes to the nurse today, not tomorrow — it can be the start of a fever or dehydration. Say it calmly, so it does not frighten him.

Hana (caregiver)

お茶(ちゃ)は 半分(はんぶん)と 報告(ほうこく)します。

I'll report it: half a cup of tea.

Why: Report an AMOUNT, never 'he drank some'. Half a lunch, half a cup, sluggish all afternoon — three facts the nurse can act on, written down the same way by every shift.

2 · Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	半分(はんぶん)	*hanbun*	half	
2	食欲(しょくよく)	*shokuyoku*	appetite	
3	痛(いた)い	*itai*	painful; it hurts (recycled from Ep 25)	
4	だるい	*darui*	sluggish; heavy and tired	
5	飲(の)む	*nomu*	to drink	
6	喉(のど)	*nodo*	throat	
7	渇(かわ)く	*kawaku*	to be thirsty (of the throat)	
8	少(すこ)しずつ	*sukoshizutsu*	little by little	
9	冷(つめ)たい	*tsumetai*	cold (to the touch)	
10	持(も)つ	*motsu*	to hold; bring	
11	一口(ひとくち)	*hitokuchi*	one mouthful; one sip	
12	大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)	*daijoubu*	okay; all right (recycled from Ep 24)	
13	コップ	*koppu*	cup; glass	

14	来(く)る	*kuru*	to come	
15	看護師(かんごし)	*kangoshi*	nurse (recycled from Ep 25)	
16	伝(つた)える	*tsutaeru*	to tell; pass on (recycled from Ep 25)	
17	報告(ほうこく)する	*houkokusuru*	to report (recycled from Ep 25)	

3 · Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
少(すこ)しずつ 飲(の)みませんか	Offer a drink — invite, never order
一口(ひとくち)だけでも 大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)ですよ	Lower the bar so he can start
コップ 半分(はんぶん) 飲(の)めましたね	Notice the amount and praise it
3時(じ)に また 来(き)ますね	Make 'later' a real time, then keep it
お茶(ちゃ)は 半分(はんぶん)と 報告(ほうこく)します	Report an amount, never 'some'

4 · Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	What does Yamada-san say at the start? A) あまり 食欲(しょくよく)が ないんです B) 喉(のど)が 渇(かわ)きました C) 熱(ねつ)が あります D) よく 聞(き)こえません	
2	What can Yamada-san drink? A) お水(みず) B) 冷(つめ)たい お茶(ちゃ) C) ジュース D) 何(なに)も 飲(の)みません	
3	Invite him to drink a little at a time.	
4	Tell him even just one sip is fine.	
5	Say you'll report half a cup of tea.	

5 · Answer Key — こたえ

1. あまり 食欲(しょくよく)が ないんです。
2. 冷(つめ)たい お茶(ちゃ)なら、飲(の)めます。
3. 少(すこ)しずつ 飲(の)みませんか。
4. 一口(ひとくち)だけでも 大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)ですよ。
5. お茶(ちゃ)は 半分(はんぶん)と 報告(ほうこく)します。